

WTF : A (Causal) relationship btw x_i and y_i .

A Quick Review of OLS

A simple reg model w/ one exp variable (x_i).

$$y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i + u_i \quad i = \text{obs} \quad \text{assuming } E(u_i | x_i) = 0$$

①

$$\begin{aligned} y_i &= \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i + u_i \\ \rightarrow \bar{y} &= \beta_0 + \beta_1 \bar{x} + \bar{u} \end{aligned}$$

$$\hat{\beta}_1 = \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})}{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2} = \frac{\text{Cov}(x_i, y_i)}{\text{Var}(x_i)}$$

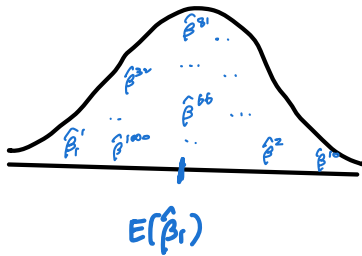
$$y_i - \bar{y} = \beta_1 (x_i - \bar{x}) + (u_i - \bar{u})$$

What does "bias" mean?

From random sampling with a large sample,

if we estimate β_1 multiple times, we have $\hat{\beta}_1^1, \hat{\beta}_1^2, \hat{\beta}_1^3 \dots \hat{\beta}_1^{1000}$ (1,000 times)

If we plot all these values and if it looks like this:



then $E(\hat{\beta}_1) = \beta_1$.

On average, estimated $\hat{\beta}_1$ equals the true parameter β_1 .

In this case, we say that $\hat{\beta}_1$ is unbiased.

To sum up, we say that $\hat{\beta}_1$ is unbiased if $E(\hat{\beta}_1) = \beta_1$.

Is $\hat{\beta}_1$ from the OLS unbiased?

$$\hat{\beta}_1 = \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})(y_i - \bar{y})}{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2} \stackrel{①}{=} \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x}) [\beta_1 (x_i - \bar{x}) + (u_i - \bar{u})]}{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2}$$

$$= \beta_1 + \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})(u_i - \bar{u})}{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2}$$

$$E(\hat{\beta}_1) = E \left[\beta_1 + \frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})(u_i - \bar{u})}{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2} \right]$$

$$= \beta_1 + E \left[\frac{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})(u_i - \bar{u})}{\sum (x_i - \bar{x})^2} \right] \quad \text{because } E(u_i | x_i) = 0$$

What if $E(u_i | x_i) \neq 0$?

Then, we have something other than β_1 .
 $\therefore \hat{\beta}_1$ is biased.

What is Omitted Variable Bias?

Suppose the true model is

$$y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{1i} + \beta_2 x_{2i} + \varepsilon_i$$

where $E[u_i | x_{1i}, x_{2i}] = 0$

If we mistakenly run a regression w/o x_2 ,

$$y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{1i} + u_i, \text{ where } u_i = x_{2i} + \varepsilon_i$$

$$\tilde{\beta}_1 = \frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)(y_i - \bar{y})}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2} \stackrel{b)}{=} \frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1) [\beta_1 (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1) + \beta_2 (x_{2i} - \bar{x}_2) + (u_i - \bar{u})]}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2}$$

$$= \beta_1 + \beta_2 \cdot \frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)(x_{2i} - \bar{x}_2)}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2} + \frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)(u_i - \bar{u})}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2}$$

$$E[\tilde{\beta}_1] = E \left[\beta_1 + \beta_2 \cdot \frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)(x_{2i} - \bar{x}_2)}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2} + \frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)(u_i - \bar{u})}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2} \right]$$

$$= \beta_1 + \beta_2 E \left[\frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)(x_{2i} - \bar{x}_2)}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2} \right] + E \left[\frac{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)(u_i - \bar{u})}{\sum (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1)^2} \right]$$

$$= \beta_1 + \beta_2 \cdot \frac{\text{Cov}(x_1, x_2)}{\text{Var}(x_1)}$$

Isn't this familiar?

$$= \beta_1 + \beta_2 \cdot \delta_1$$

Direct rel
btw y & x_1

Direct rel
tw x_1 & x_2

Direct rel
btw y & x_2

$$= \beta_1 + \underbrace{\beta_2 \delta_1}_{\text{Bias}}$$

b)

$$y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{1i} + \beta_2 x_{2i} + u_i$$

$$\bar{y} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \bar{x}_1 + \beta_2 \bar{x}_2 + \bar{u}$$

$$y_i - \bar{y} = \beta_1 (x_{1i} - \bar{x}_1) + \beta_2 (x_{2i} - \bar{x}_2) + (u_i - \bar{u})$$

• regress y on x

$$y = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 x + e$$

$$\alpha_1 = \frac{\text{Cov}(x, y)}{\text{Var}(x)}$$

• what we have :

$$\frac{\text{Cov}(x_1, x_2)}{\text{Var}(x_1)}$$

⇒ It's the coeff on x_1 from regressing x_2 on x_1

$$x_2 = \delta_0 + \delta_1 x_1 + v$$

To sum up,

$$E(\tilde{\beta}_1) = \beta_1 + \beta_2 \cdot \delta_1$$

• Definition of Unbiasedness

if $\hat{\beta}_1$ is unbiased, $E(\hat{\beta}_1) = \beta_1$.

$$E(\tilde{\beta}) = \begin{cases} \beta_1 & \text{if } \beta_2 \delta_1 = 0 \text{ ("unbiased")} \Leftrightarrow \beta_2 = 0 \text{ OR } \delta_1 = 0 \\ \beta_1 + \beta_2 \delta_1 & \text{if } \beta_2 \delta_1 \neq 0 \text{ ("biased")} \Leftrightarrow \beta_2 \neq 0 \text{ AND } \delta_1 \neq 0 \end{cases}$$

($\therefore$) we call this term as "BIAS"
because it biases our estimation.

What are β_2 and δ_1 , again?

β_2 : Direct rel btw $y \in \mathcal{X}_2$ from $y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_{1i} + \beta_2 x_{2i} + \varepsilon_i$

δ_1 : Direct rel btw $x_1 \in \mathcal{X}_2$ from $x_{2i} = \delta_0 + \delta_1 x_{1i} + v_i$

Because this bias is caused by omitting x_2 , which is related to BOTH y and x_1 , we call this as Omitted Variable Bias (OVB).

Main Takeaway

if we run a regression omitting a variable that is BOTH correlated with y and x_1 , our estimate has an OVB problem.

(We cannot say that x and y have a causal relationship.)

the variable of interest

(Example) LAB4. Question 7

True model : $\ln E = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{indegree} + \beta_2 \text{female} + \beta_3 \text{friend4} + \varepsilon$ (7)

What we estimated : $\ln E = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{indegree} + \beta_2 \text{female} + u$ (6)
(in Q6)

$$E(\tilde{\beta}_1) = \beta_1 + \underbrace{\hat{\beta}_3}_{0.05} \cdot \underbrace{\hat{\delta}_1}_{0.082}$$

Bias > 0 "upward bias"

the TRUE parameter β_1 from the true model (7)

<Auxiliary regression>

$$\begin{aligned} \text{friend4} &= \delta_0 + \delta_1 \text{indegree} + v \\ &= 4.354 + 0.082 \text{indegree} \end{aligned}$$

What we estimated from Equation (6)

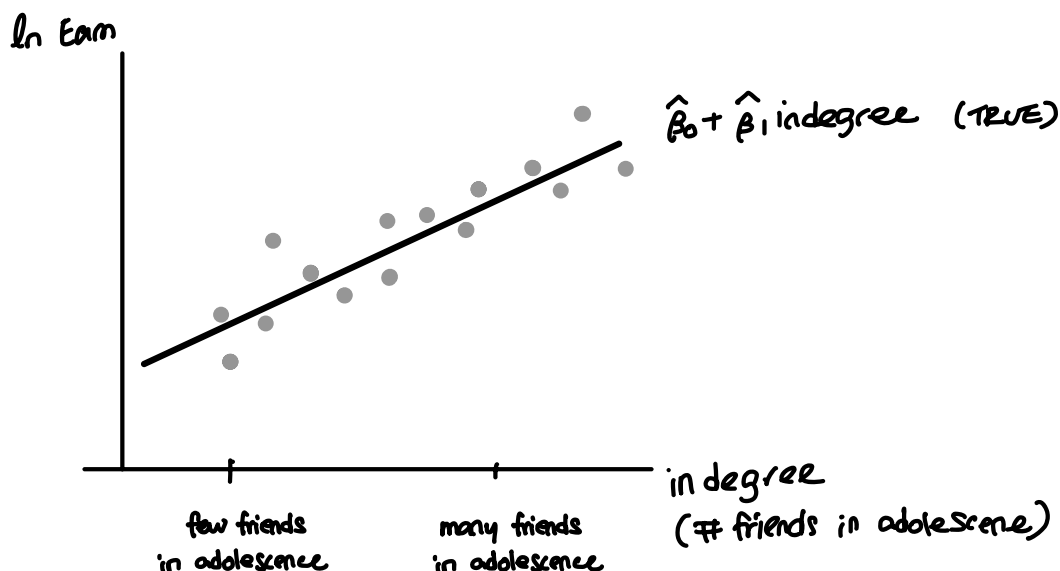
⇒ What can you say about $\tilde{\beta}_1$?

The estimated $\tilde{\beta}_1$ is larger than the true parameter β_1 .

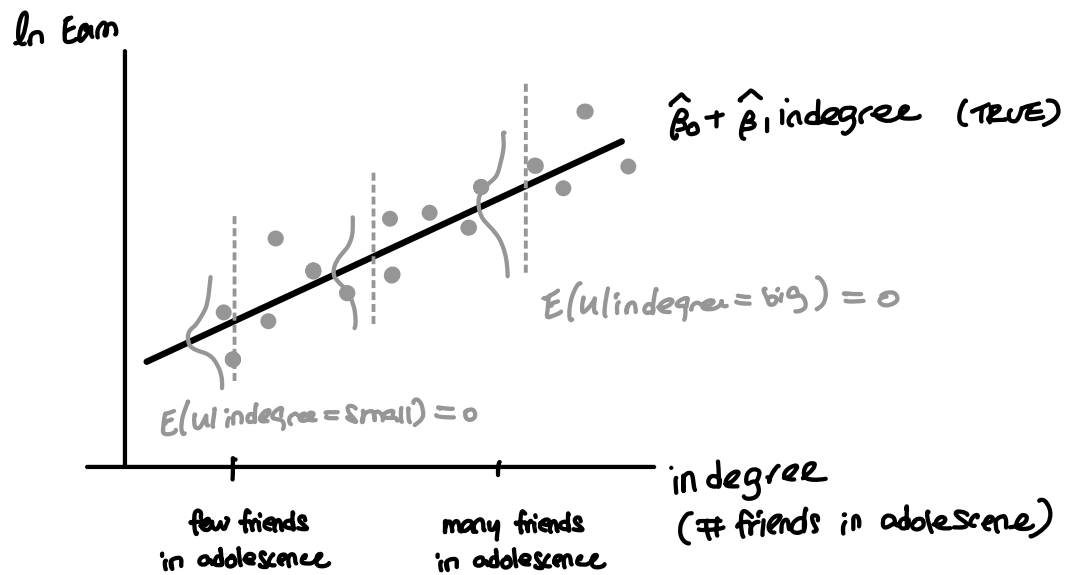
(i.e.) The true parameter is smaller than what we estimated in (6).

We also say that " $\tilde{\beta}_1$ is biased away from zero."

Suppose this is from the true model



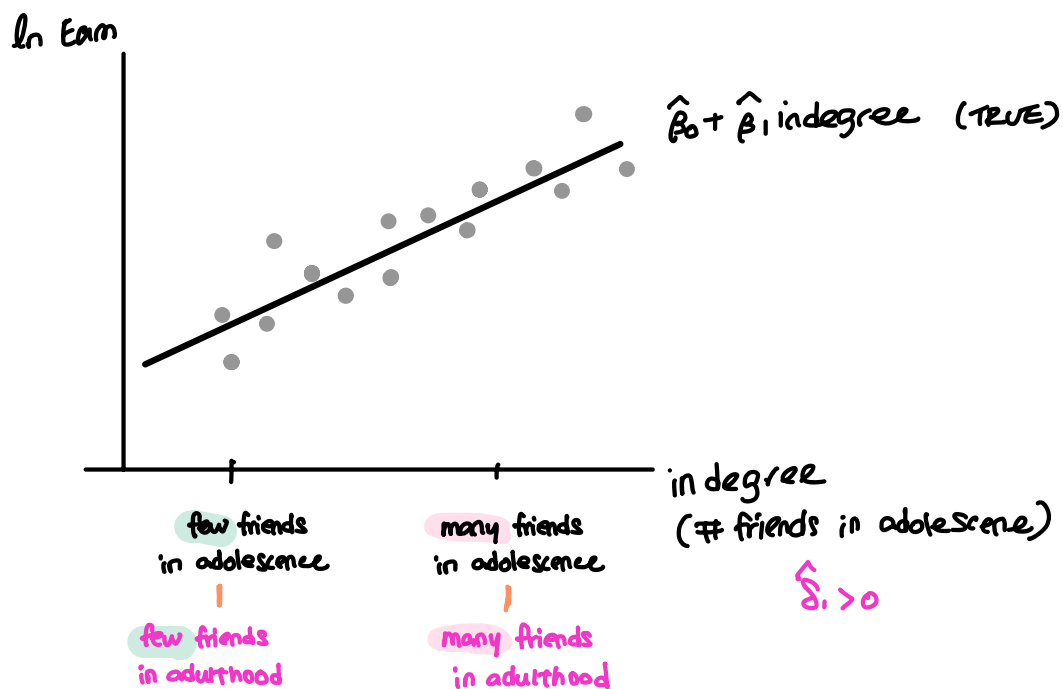
Suppose this is from the true model



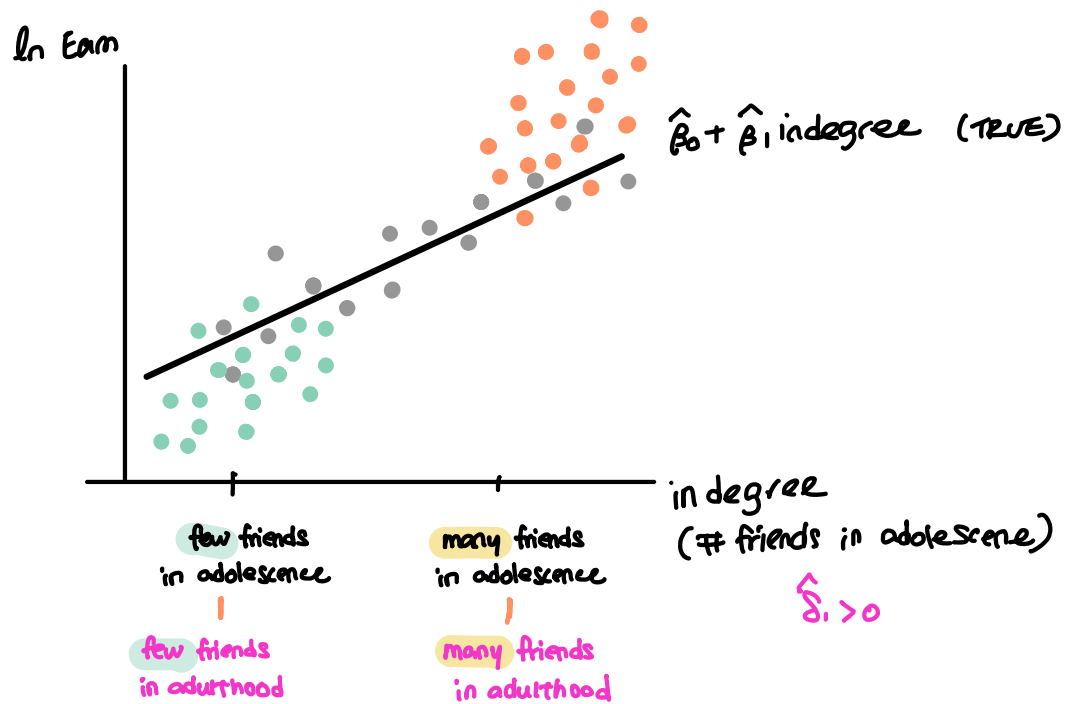
$$u = \text{friend}_4 + \varepsilon$$

However, if we omit 'Friend₄' in the model, it is now part of the error term.

$\hat{\beta}_1 > 0$: "A positive rel btw # friends in adolescence & # friends in adulthood."

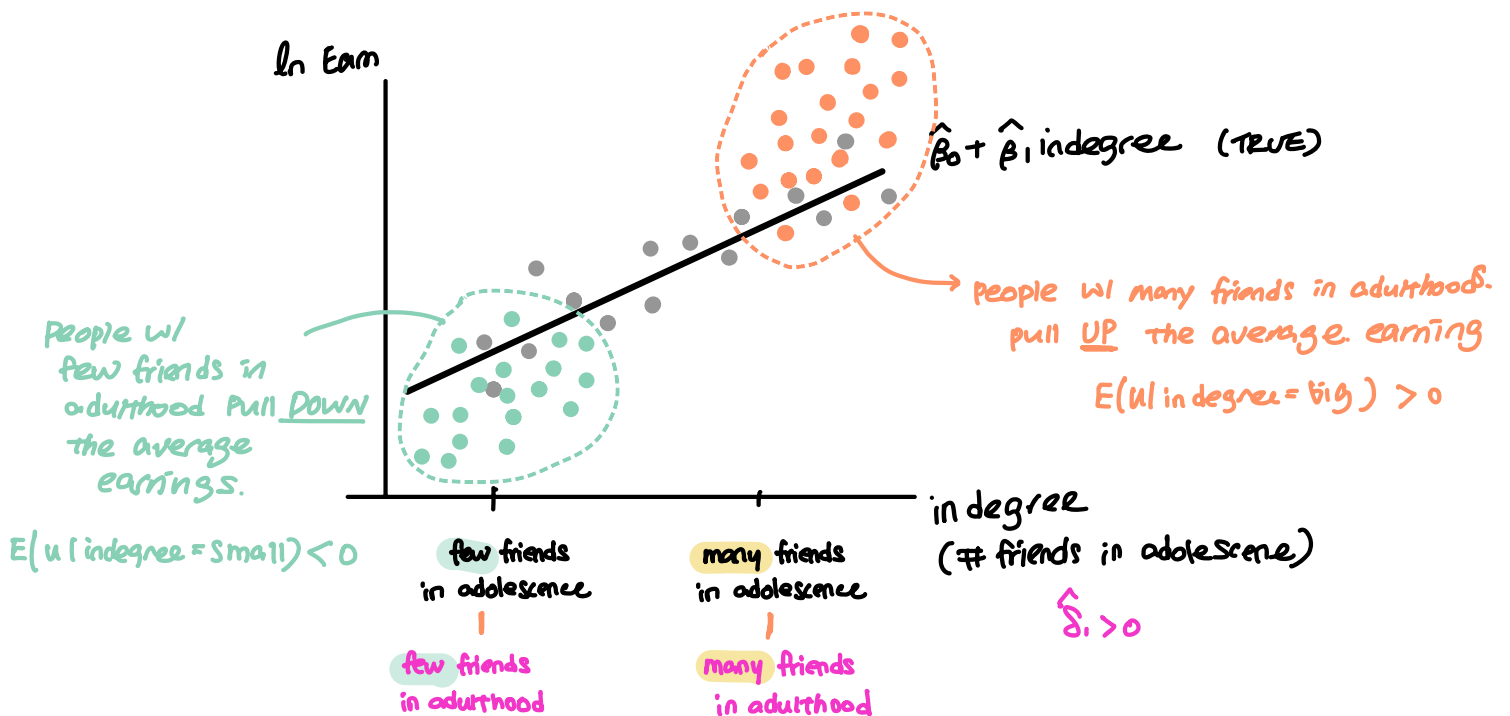


$\hat{\beta}_2 > 0$: "A positive relationship btw Earnings & # friends in adulthood."

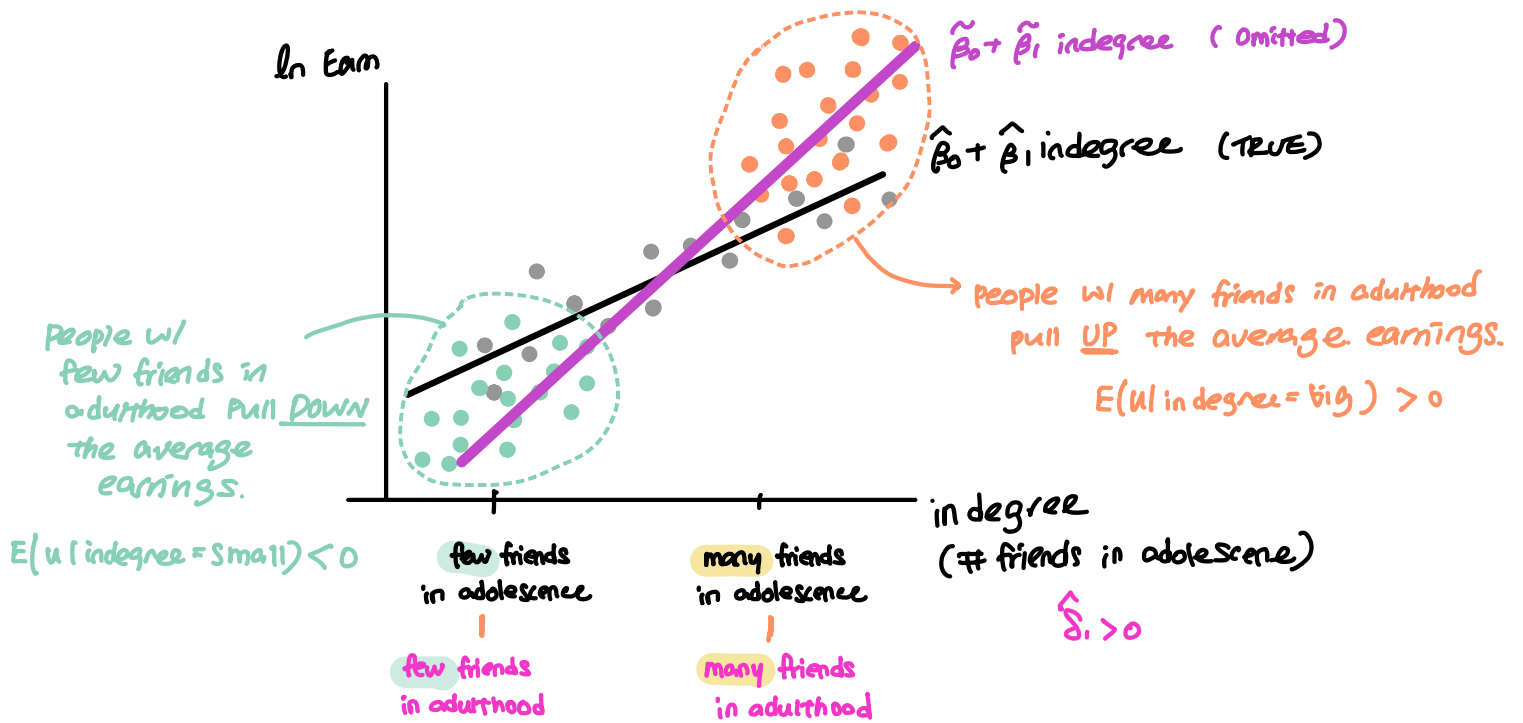


If we omit Friend_4 in the reg model, the error term $u = \text{Friend}_4 + \varepsilon$.

Because Friend_4 is correlated with lnEam AND in degree, $E[u | \text{in-degree}] \neq \phi$.



Therefore ...



True model : $\ln \text{Earn} = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{indegree} + \beta_2 \text{female} + \beta_3 \text{friend}_4 + \varepsilon$

. reg ln_earn in_degree female friend_4

Source	SS	df	MS	Number of obs	=	2,601
Model	134.501255	3	44.8337517	F(3, 2597)	=	43.03
Residual	2705.73506	2,597	1.04186949	Prob > F	=	0.0000
				R-squared	=	0.0474
				Adj R-squared	=	0.0463
Total	2840.23631	2,600	1.09239858	Root MSE	=	1.0207

ln_earn	Coefficient	Std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
$\hat{\beta}_1$ in_degree	.0200568	.005484	3.66	0.000	.0093035	.0308102
female	-.3045655	.0404073	-7.54	0.000	-.3837993	-.2253316
$\hat{\beta}_3$ friend_4	.0503541	.0073086	6.89	0.000	.0360229	.0646853
_cons	10.00184	.0513622	194.73	0.000	9.901127	10.10256

. reg friend_4 in_degree

: Friend 4 = $\delta_0 + \delta_1 \text{in degree} + v$ (Auxiliary regression)

Source	SS	df	MS	Number of obs	=	2,893
Model	268.635594	1	268.635594	F(1, 2891)	=	35.14
Residual	22103.3174	2,891	7.64556119	Prob > F	=	0.0000
				R-squared	=	0.0120
				Adj R-squared	=	0.0117
Total	22371.953	2,892	7.7358067	Root MSE	=	2.7651

friend_4	Coefficient	Std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
$\hat{\delta}_1$ in_degree	.0824532	.0139101	5.93	0.000	.0551785	.1097279
_cons	4.353976	.0828171	52.57	0.000	4.191589	4.516362

ECON 108 Discussion Section

Week 2. Simple Linear Regression Model: Practice Questions

$$Y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 X_i + u_i$$

Question 1.

$$\text{Test score}_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{STR}_i + u_i$$

Suppose we are interested in examining the effect of class size, measured by the student-teacher ratio (str), on average test scores (testscr). The following information is based on school district-level data.

. su testscr str

Variable	Obs	Mean	Std. dev.	Min	Max
Y testscr	420	654.1565 $\bar{y}$	19.05335 S_y	605.55	706.75
X str	420	19.64043 $\bar{x}$	1.891812 S_x	14	25.8

. corr testscr str, cov
(obs=420)

	testscr	str
Y testscr	363.03 $\rightarrow S_y^2$	
X str	-8.15932 $\text{cov}(X, Y)$	3.57895 $\rightarrow S_x^2$

	X_1	X_2
X_1	$\text{cov}(X_1, X_1) = V(X_1)$	
X_2	$\text{cov}(X_1, X_2)$	$\text{cov}(X_2, X_2) = V(X_2)$

Let's calculate the estimated coefficients manually.

- a. What is $\hat{\beta}_1$? $\hat{\beta}_0$? Interpret $\hat{\beta}_1$.

$$\hat{\beta}_1 = \frac{\text{cov}(X, Y)}{S_x^2} = \frac{-8.159}{3.79} = -2.28$$

When a school district's STR increases by one student per class, test scores decrease by 2.28 points.

$$\hat{\beta}_0 = \bar{y} - \hat{\beta}_1 \bar{x} = 654.157 - (-2.28)(19.64) = 698.936$$

- b. What is R^2 ? Interpret the meaning of the number.

$$R^2 = (r^2) = (-0.226)^2 = 0.051$$

$$r = \frac{\text{cov}(X, Y)}{S_x \cdot S_y} = \frac{-8.159}{(1.892)(19.053)} = -0.226$$

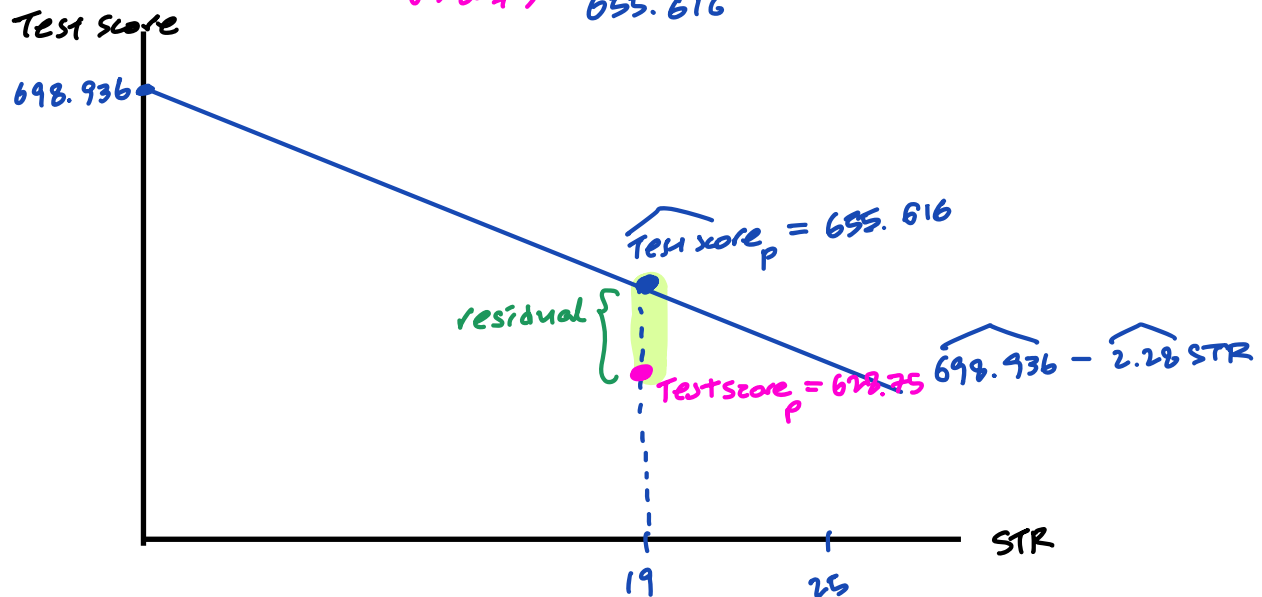
$$\text{STR} = 19$$

c. Predict testscr if the student-teacher ratio (str) is 19.

$$\begin{aligned} \widehat{\text{Test score}} &= \hat{\beta}_0 + \hat{\beta}_1 \text{STR} \\ &= 698.936 - 2.28 \text{STR} \\ &= 698.936 - 2.28 (19) \\ &= 655.616 \end{aligned}$$

d. The student-teacher ratio for Perris School District is 19, and the average test score is $\checkmark 628.75$. In the graph below, draw the estimated regression line and label the following for Perris School District:

- STR
- Actual average test score
- Predicted average test score
- residual = $628.75 - 655.616$



Did we calculate everything correctly?

```
. reg testscr str
```

Source	SS	df	MS	Number of obs	=	420
Model	7794.11004	1	7794.11004	F(1, 418)	=	22.58
Residual	144315.484	418	345.252353	Prob > F	=	0.0000
				R-squared	=	0.0512
				Adj R-squared	=	0.0490
Total	152109.594	419	363.030056	Root MSE	=	18.581

testscr	Coefficient	Std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
str	-2.279808 $\hat{\beta}_1$	.4798256	-4.75	0.000	-3.22298	-1.336637
_cons	698.933 $\hat{\beta}_0$	9.467491	73.82	0.000	680.3231	717.5428

```
. margins, at(str=19)
```

Adjusted predictions
Model VCE: OLS

Number of obs = 420

Expression: Linear prediction, predict()
At: str = 19

	Delta-method					
	Margin	std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
_cons	655.6166	.9573181	684.85	0.000	653.7348	657.4984

Question 2.

We are also interested in the relationship between the number of computers and average test scores. The regression results are presented below, with standard errors shown in parentheses.

$$\widehat{TestScore}_i = \underbrace{655.122}_{\hat{\beta}_0} - \underbrace{0.003}_{\hat{\beta}_1} Computer_i \quad (1) \quad \checkmark$$

$$\widehat{TestScore}_i = 643.36 - 79.40 Computer \text{ per Student}_i \quad (2)$$

(2.08) (13.81)

- a. Interpret the estimated coefficients. (Choose one model.)

Slope $\hat{\beta}_1$: Additional computer in a school district decreases test scores by 0.003, all else equal.

Intercept $\hat{\beta}_0$: ^{when} a school district has zero computers, predicted test scores are 655.122.

H_0

H_a

- b. Conduct a significance test at the 5% level to evaluate whether there is any relationship between the number of computers and average test scores. Show all your steps. Be sure to show how you calculate the necessary probabilities from a z table.

① | $H_0: \beta_1 = 0 \equiv \beta_{1,0}$ ← no relationship btw #comp & test scores
 $H_a: \beta_1 \neq 0$ ← there is a relationship



② sig lv (α) = 0.05

③ test statistic = $\frac{\hat{\beta}_1 - \text{mean of } \hat{\beta}_1 \text{ under } H_0}{\text{sd of } \hat{\beta}_1 \text{ under } H_0}$

• mean of $\hat{\beta}_1$
 $= E(\hat{\beta}_1) = \beta_1$

under H_0 , $\beta_{1,0}$

• sd of $\hat{\beta}_1 \rightarrow \text{se}(\hat{\beta}_1)$

$$= \frac{\hat{\beta}_1 - \beta_{1,0}}{\text{se}(\hat{\beta}_1)}$$

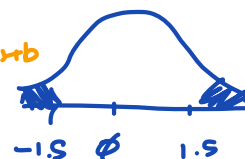
$$= \frac{\hat{\beta}_1 - 0}{\text{se}(\hat{\beta}_1)}$$

$$= \frac{\hat{\beta}_1}{\text{se}(\hat{\beta}_1)} = \frac{-0.003}{0.002} = \underline{\underline{-1.5}}$$

④ p-value $\Rightarrow P(|t| > |\text{test statistic}|)$

$$= P(|t| > 1.5)$$

t distb $\approx$ z distb
when sample
size is large!



$$= 2 \times P\left(\frac{z}{t} < -1.5\right)$$

0.0668 z-table!

$$= \underline{\underline{0.1336}}$$

⑤ Conclusion

p-value vs sig lv (α)

0.1336 >

0.05

$\Rightarrow$ fail to reject H_0

(no relationship
btw # computers
and test scores.)

- c. Construct a 95% confidence interval for the slope parameter. Discuss how the results are complementary to your findings in part b).

* not $\hat{\beta}_1$ 😞

A 95% CI for $\beta_1 = \hat{\beta}_1 \pm 1.96 \cdot se(\hat{\beta}_1)$

$$= -0.003 \pm 1.96 (0.002)$$

$$= -0.003 \pm 0.004$$

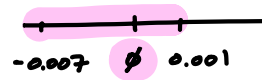
95% of the time

β_1 is w/in this interval

$$= [-0.003 - 0.004, -0.003 + 0.004]$$

$$= [-0.007, 0.001]$$

contains 0



$\therefore$ We cannot rule out that β_1 is zero.

no relationship btw # computers
and test scores

The actual regression results are shown below. How accurate were our manual calculations of the test statistic, p-value, and confidence interval (CI)?

. reg testscr computer

Source	SS	df	MS	Number of obs	=	420
Model	827.015554	1	827.015554	F(1, 418)	=	2.29
Residual	151282.578	418	361.920043	Prob > F	=	0.1314
				R-squared	=	0.0054
				Adj R-squared	=	0.0031
Total	152109.594	419	363.030056	Root MSE	=	19.024

testscr	Coefficient	Std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
computer	-.0031833	.0021058	-1.51	0.131	-.0073226	.0009561
_cons	655.1223	1.126888	581.36	0.000	652.9072	657.3374

test stat
Q6③

p-value
Q6④

Q3.

. reg testscr comp_stu

Source	SS	df	MS	Number of obs	=	420
Model	11146.6436	1	11146.6436	F(1, 418)	=	33.05
Residual	140962.95	418	337.231938	Prob > F	=	0.0000
				R-squared	=	0.0733
				Adj R-squared	=	0.0711
Total	152109.594	419	363.030056	Root MSE	=	18.364

testscr	Coefficient	Std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
comp_stu	79.40485	13.81145	5.75	0.000	52.2563	106.5534
_cons	643.3633	2.080229	309.28	0.000	639.2743	647.4523

STANDARD NORMAL DISTRIBUTION: Table Values Represent AREA to the LEFT of the Z score.

Z	.00	.01	.02	.03	.04	.05	.06	.07	.08	.09
-3.9	.00005	.00005	.00004	.00004	.00004	.00004	.00004	.00004	.00003	.00003
-3.8	.00007	.00007	.00007	.00006	.00006	.00006	.00006	.00005	.00005	.00005
-3.7	.00011	.00010	.00010	.00010	.00009	.00009	.00008	.00008	.00008	.00008
-3.6	.00016	.00015	.00015	.00014	.00014	.00013	.00013	.00012	.00012	.00011
-3.5	.00023	.00022	.00022	.00021	.00020	.00019	.00019	.00018	.00017	.00017
-3.4	.00034	.00032	.00031	.00030	.00029	.00028	.00027	.00026	.00025	.00024
-3.3	.00048	.00047	.00045	.00043	.00042	.00040	.00039	.00038	.00036	.00035
-3.2	.00069	.00066	.00064	.00062	.00060	.00058	.00056	.00054	.00052	.00050
-3.1	.00097	.00094	.00090	.00087	.00084	.00082	.00079	.00076	.00074	.00071
-3.0	.00135	.00131	.00126	.00122	.00118	.00114	.00111	.00107	.00104	.00100
-2.9	.00187	.00181	.00175	.00169	.00164	.00159	.00154	.00149	.00144	.00139
-2.8	.00256	.00248	.00240	.00233	.00226	.00219	.00212	.00205	.00199	.00193
-2.7	.00347	.00336	.00326	.00317	.00307	.00298	.00289	.00280	.00272	.00264
-2.6	.00466	.00453	.00440	.00427	.00415	.00402	.00391	.00379	.00368	.00357
-2.5	.00621	.00604	.00587	.00570	.00554	.00539	.00523	.00508	.00494	.00480
-2.4	.00820	.00798	.00776	.00755	.00734	.00714	.00695	.00676	.00657	.00639
-2.3	.01072	.01044	.01017	.00990	.00964	.00939	.00914	.00889	.00866	.00842
-2.2	.01390	.01355	.01321	.01287	.01255	.01222	.01191	.01160	.01130	.01101
-2.1	.01786	.01743	.01700	.01659	.01618	.01578	.01539	.01500	.01463	.01426
-2.0	.02275	.02222	.02169	.02118	.02068	.02018	.01970	.01923	.01876	.01831
-1.9	.02872	.02807	.02743	.02680	.02619	.02559	.02500	.02442	.02385	.02330
-1.8	.03593	.03515	.03438	.03362	.03288	.03216	.03144	.03074	.03005	.02938
-1.7	.04457	.04363	.04272	.04182	.04093	.04006	.03920	.03836	.03754	.03673
-1.6	.05480	.05370	.05262	.05155	.05050	.04947	.04846	.04746	.04648	.04551
-1.5	.06681	.06552	.06426	.06301	.06178	.06057	.05938	.05821	.05705	.05592
-1.4	.08076	.07927	.07780	.07636	.07493	.07353	.07215	.07078	.06944	.06811
-1.3	.09680	.09510	.09342	.09176	.09012	.08851	.08691	.08534	.08379	.08226
-1.2	.11507	.11314	.11123	.10935	.10749	.10565	.10383	.10204	.10027	.09853
-1.1	.13567	.13350	.13136	.12924	.12714	.12507	.12302	.12100	.11900	.11702
-1.0	.15866	.15625	.15386	.15151	.14917	.14686	.14457	.14231	.14007	.13786
-0.9	.18406	.18141	.17879	.17619	.17361	.17106	.16853	.16602	.16354	.16109
-0.8	.21186	.20897	.20611	.20327	.20045	.19766	.19489	.19215	.18943	.18673
-0.7	.24196	.23885	.23576	.23270	.22965	.22663	.22363	.22065	.21770	.21476
-0.6	.27425	.27093	.26763	.26435	.26109	.25785	.25463	.25143	.24825	.24510
-0.5	.30854	.30503	.30153	.29806	.29460	.29116	.28774	.28434	.28096	.27760
-0.4	.34458	.34090	.33724	.33360	.32997	.32636	.32276	.31918	.31561	.31207
-0.3	.38209	.37828	.37448	.37070	.36693	.36317	.35942	.35569	.35197	.34827
-0.2	.42074	.41683	.41294	.40905	.40517	.40129	.39743	.39358	.38974	.38591
-0.1	.46017	.45620	.45224	.44828	.44433	.44038	.43644	.43251	.42858	.42465
-0.0	.50000	.49601	.49202	.48803	.48405	.48006	.47608	.47210	.46812	.46414

ECON 108 Discussion Section slope

Week 3. Multiple Linear Regression Model & Nonlinear Models

$$y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x + u \rightarrow \frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x} = \beta_1$$

- **Agenda for week 3:** Expand a simple linear regression model by adding additional variables and incorporating nonlinear functions for the dependent and/or explanatory variables.

- **Shapes of a Quadratic Model:** $y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x + \beta_2 x^2 + u$ $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x} = \frac{dy}{dx} = \beta_1 + 2\beta_2 x$

The turnaround point? $\frac{\Delta y}{\Delta x} = 0 \Rightarrow \beta_1 + 2\beta_2 x = 0$

How to tell the shape of the model based on the signs of coefficients? (Or vice versa.)

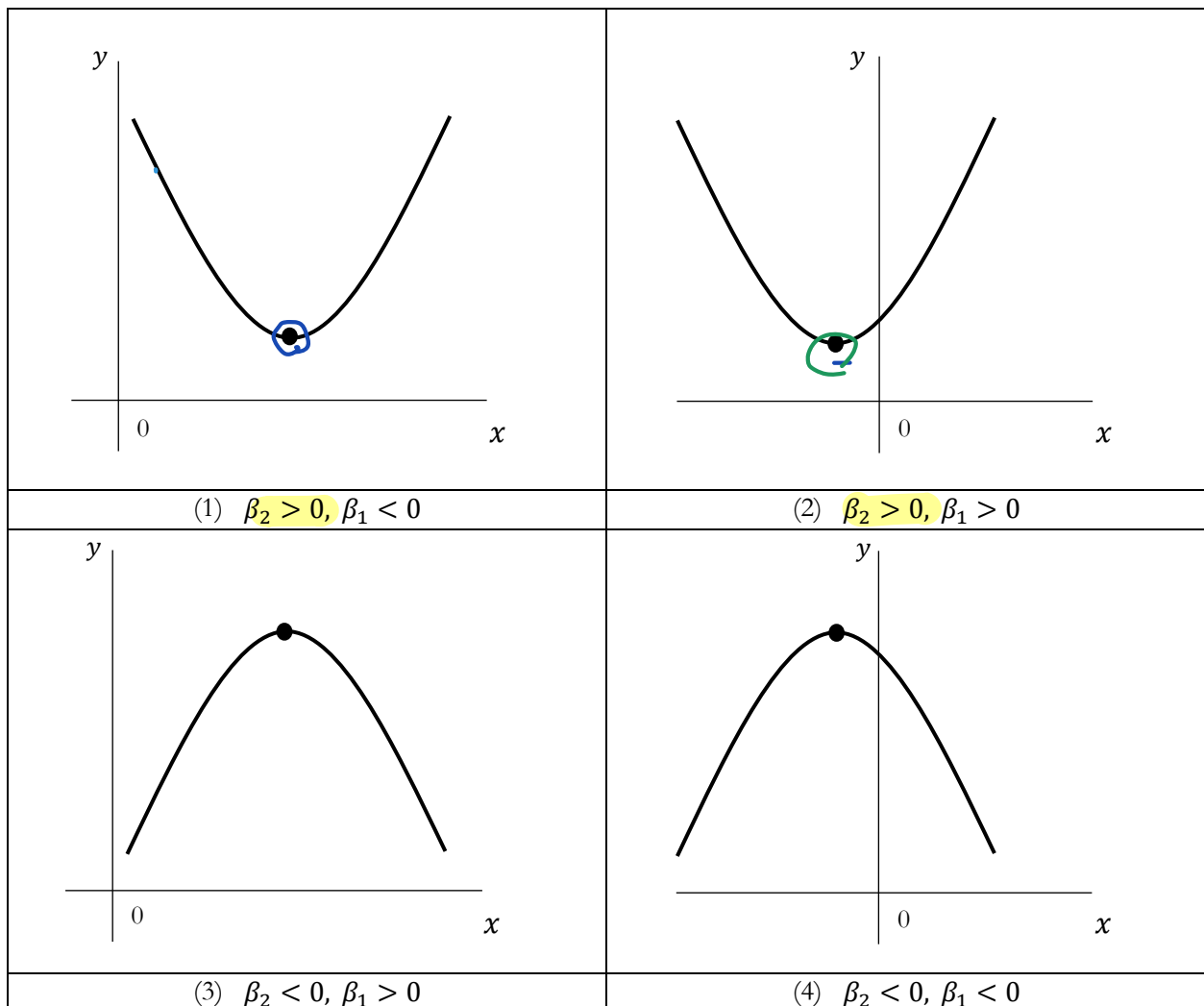
1. Check the sign of coefficient for x^2 (β_2)

- a. $\beta_2 > 0$: a U-shaped curve (1) and (2)
- b. $\beta_2 < 0$: an inverted U-shape curve (3) and (4)

2. Check the coefficient for x (β_1):

- a. If β_1 and β_2 have the same sign, the turning point is negative. (2) and (4)
- b. If β_1 and β_2 have the opposite signs, the turning point is positive. (1) and (3)

$$x^* = -\frac{\beta_1}{2\beta_2}$$



- Testing the nonlinear relationship between y and x in a quadratic model:

$$y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x + \beta_2 x^2 + u$$

$$y = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x + u$$

$H_0: \beta_2 = 0$ (i.e., no need for a quadratic term)

$H_a: \beta_2 \neq 0$ (i.e., the quadratic term is necessary)

- Interpreting nonlinear regression models

Case	Regression	Interpretation	
lin-lin	$y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i + u_i$ $\Delta y = \beta_1 \Delta x$	A change in x by one unit is associated with a change in y by β_1 (unit), on average.	x : unit of x y : unit of y
lin-log	$y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \ln x_i + u_i$	A 1% change in x is associated with $0.01 \cdot \beta_1$ change in y , on average.	x : % y : unit
log-lin	$\ln y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 x_i + u_i$	A change in x by one unit is associated with a $100 \cdot \beta_1$ % change in y , on average.	x : unit of x y : %
log-log	$\ln y_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \ln x_i + u_i$	A 1% change in x is associated with a β_1 % change in y , on average. β_1 is the elasticity of y with respect to X .	x : % y : %

lin-log

$$\Delta y = \beta_1 \cdot \Delta \ln x \times 100$$

$$\Delta y \cdot 100 = \beta_1 \cdot \% \Delta x$$

$$\Delta y = \left(\frac{\beta_1}{100} \right) \% \Delta x$$

log-lin

$$\Delta \ln y = \beta_1 \Delta x \times 100$$

$$\% \Delta y = (\beta_1 \times 100) \Delta x$$

Useful fact

$$\Delta \ln x \times 100 = \% \Delta x$$

log-log

$$\Delta \ln y = \beta_1 \cdot \Delta \ln x \times 100$$

$$\% \Delta y = \beta_1 \cdot \% \Delta x$$

Question 1.

Consider the following regression model that examines the relationship between the number of bedrooms and housing price:

$$Price_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 Room_i + \beta_2 Room_i^2 + u_i$$

- a. What is the marginal effect of an additional bedroom on housing price?

$$\frac{\Delta Price}{\Delta Room} = \frac{d Price}{d Room} = \beta_1 + 2\beta_2 \cdot Room$$

- b. What is the predicted marginal effect of an additional bedroom on housing price for a house with 2 bedrooms = $Room$

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\Delta Price}{\Delta Room} &= \beta_1 + 2\beta_2 \cdot \boxed{Room}^{=2} \\ &= \beta_1 + 4\beta_2 \end{aligned}$$

- c. Suppose we run an alternative model as follows. Interpret the coefficient on $\ln(Size_i)$. The unit of Size is square feet.

log-log $\ln(Price_i) = \alpha_0 + \alpha_1 \ln(Size_i) + \alpha_2 Room_i + u_i$

if the size of a house increases by 1%,
the housing price changes by α_1 %.

Question 2.

For the following scenario, predict the signs of the coefficients. Trace out the shape of the relationship between the dependent variable and the explanatory variable.

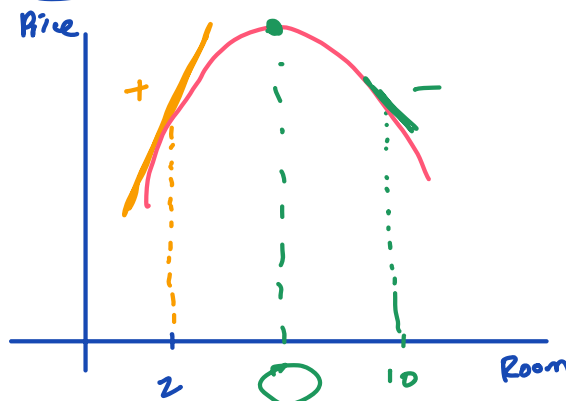
$$Price = \beta_0 + \beta_1 Room + \beta_2 Room^2 + u$$

Slope → The change in housing price from adding one room is \$50,000 when the current house has 2 bedrooms. The change in housing price from adding one room is -\$10,000 when the current house has 10 bedrooms.

$$\frac{\Delta Price}{\Delta Room} = \frac{d Price}{d Room} = \beta_1 + 2\beta_2 Room$$

slope

$$\text{slope} \begin{cases} 50,000 & \text{at } Room = 2 \\ -10,000 & \text{at } Room = 10 \end{cases}$$



① $\beta_2 < 0$ b/c the slope changes from (+) to (-)

② $\beta_1 > 0$ b/c the turning pt is a ³positive number (somewhere btw 2 & 10), and $\beta_2 < 0$. For the turning pt to be positive, β_1 & β_2 must have opposite signs.

Question 3.

Our research on examining the relationship between the number of computers per student and average test scores continues this week. This time, we include the computer-student ratio (comp_stu) and its squared term (comp_stu2) to investigate whether the relationship between the computer-student ratio and test scores (testscr) is nonlinear. Additionally, the model controls for the student-teacher ratio (str). Use the following Stata results to answer the questions.

```
. gen comp_stu2 = comp_stu^2
```

```
. reg testscr comp_stu comp_stu2 str
```

$$\text{Score}_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{CSR}_i + \beta_2 \text{CSR}_i^2 + \beta_3 \text{STR}_i + u_i$$

Source	SS	df	MS	Number of obs	=	420
Model	15164.5307	3	5054.84358	F(3, 416)	=	15.36
Residual	136945.063	416	329.194863	Prob > F	=	0.0000
				R-squared	=	0.0997
				Adj R-squared	=	0.0932
Total	152109.594	419	363.030056	Root MSE	=	18.144

testscr	Coefficient	Std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
comp_stu	123.1777	46.28552	2.66	0.008	32.19501	214.1603
comp_stu2	-173.3259	131.4739	-1.32	0.188	-431.7619	85.11018
str	-1.533944	.4943405	-3.10	0.002	-2.505661	-.5622273
_cons	671.4727	11.16598	60.14	0.000	649.5239	693.4214

- a. Interpret the coefficient of the student-teacher ratio (str).

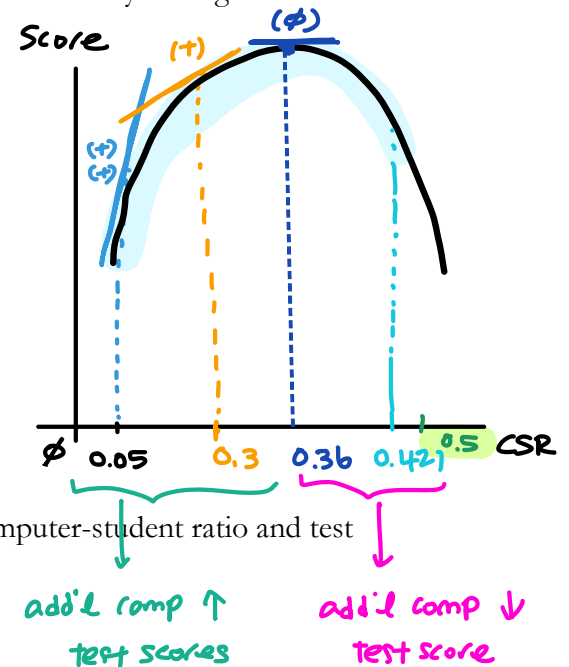
$\hat{\beta}_3 = -1.53$ "An add'l student per class decreases test scores by 1.53 points, all else equal."

- b. The computer-student ratio in the Anaheim Elementary School District is 0.05. What is the <predicted change in test scores> if the district purchases one additional computer per student?

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\Delta \text{Score}}{\Delta \text{CSR}} &= \frac{\partial \text{Score}}{\partial \text{CSR}} = \hat{\beta}_1 + 2\hat{\beta}_2 \text{CSR}^{0.05} \\ &= 123.18 + 2 \cdot (-173.33) (0.05) \\ &= \underline{105.85} \end{aligned}$$

- c. The computer-student ratio in the Portola Valley Elementary School District is 0.3. What is the predicted change in test scores if the district purchases one additional computer per student? Will the change in test scores for Portola Valley Elementary be larger or smaller compared to your answer in part b?

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\Delta \text{Score}}{\Delta \text{CSR}} &= \hat{\beta}_1 + 2\hat{\beta}_2 \cdot \text{CSR} \\ &= 123.18 + 2(-173.33)(0.3) \\ &= 19.182\end{aligned}$$



- d. Find the turning point in the relationship between the computer-student ratio and test scores.

$$\text{Turning pt} \Rightarrow \frac{\Delta \text{Score}}{\Delta \text{CSR}} = 0$$

$$\therefore \hat{\beta}_1 + 2\hat{\beta}_2 \cdot \text{CSR} = 0$$

$$\therefore \text{CSR}^* = -\frac{\hat{\beta}_1}{2\hat{\beta}_2} = \frac{-123.18}{2 \cdot (-173.33)} = 0.36$$

- e. Refer to the following information and your answer in b. Do you think the turning point is relevant? Explain.

. su comp_stu

Variable	Obs	Mean	Std. dev.	Min	Max
comp_stu	420	.1359266	.0649558	0	.4208333

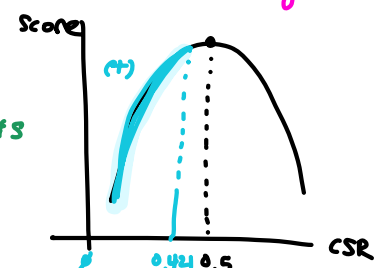
Yes. For school districts w/ a CSR below the turning pt (0.36),

adding on add'l comp per student increases test scores, on avg.

However, for districts w/ a CSR above the turning pt (btw 0.36 & 0.421), adding one more comp per student decreases test scores, on avg.

= What if the turning pt were 0.5?

⇒ No. The turning pt is NOT relevant b/c there are no districts w/ a CSR above 0.5. Therefore, in practice, an add'l comp per student only has a positive effect on test scores.



- f. Conduct a significance test at the 5% level to evaluate whether the relationship between the computer-student ratio and test scores is linear. You may use the information in the Stata output.

$$\text{Score}_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{CSR}_i + \beta_2 \text{CSR}_i^2 + \beta_3 \text{STR}_i + u_i$$

$$\begin{aligned} \textcircled{1} \quad & H_0: \beta_2 = 0 \equiv \beta_{2,0} \leftarrow (\text{linear}) \\ & H_a: \beta_2 \neq 0 \leftarrow (\text{non linear}) \end{aligned}$$

$$\textcircled{2} \quad \text{sig. lv } \alpha = 0.05$$

$$\textcircled{3} \quad \text{test statistic} = \frac{\hat{\beta}_2 - \beta_{2,0}}{\text{se}(\hat{\beta}_2)} = \frac{\hat{\beta}_2}{\text{se}(\hat{\beta}_2)} = \boxed{-1.32}$$

Stata table

$$\begin{aligned} \textcircled{4} \quad \text{p-value} &= P(|t| > |\text{test statistic}|) \\ &= P(|t| > 1.32) \\ &= \boxed{0.188} \end{aligned}$$

⑤ conclusion

$$\text{p-value} \quad \underline{vs} \quad \alpha$$

$$0.188 > 0.05 \Rightarrow \text{We fail to reject } H_0$$

that CSR and scores have "linear" relationship.

Appendix: Let's practice interpreting Stata's regression results

We run the following regression model using school district-level data:

$$\text{Testscore}_i = \beta_0 + \beta_1 \text{CompStudent}_i + \beta_2 \text{CompStudent}_i^2 + \beta_3 \text{STR}_i + u_i, \text{ where } i \text{ represents the school district,}$$

testscr: Average test scores

str: Student-Teacher Ratio

comp_stu: Computer-Student Ratio

comp_stu2: Computer-Student Ratio squared

testscr	Coefficient	Std. err.	t	P> t	[95% conf. interval]	
comp_stu	123.1777	46.28552	2.66	0.008	32.19501	214.1603
comp_stu2	-173.3259	131.4739	-1.32	0.188	-431.7619	85.11018
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_cons	671.4727	11.16598	60.14	0.000	649.5239	693.4214

Q1. Fill out the table

	Coefficient	Estimated Coefficient	Standard error of estimated coefficient	Test statistic (t-statistic) of the estimated coefficient	p-value of the estimated coefficient	A 95% CI for the parameter [LB, UB]
CompStudent	β_1	$\widehat{\beta}_1 =$	$se(\widehat{\beta}_1) =$			[,]
STR	β_3					
Constant (y-intercept)						

Note. CI= Confidence Interval; LB=Lower Bound; UB=Upper Bound

Q2. Calculate the test statistic for $\widehat{\beta}_3$ manually and compare it with the test statistic shown in the Stata table.

Q3. Is the estimated coefficient on *STR* statistically significant at the 5% level?

ANSWERS

Q1.

	Coefficient (Parameter)	Estimated Coefficient	SE of estimated coeff	Test statistic (t-statistic) of the estimated coefficient	p-value of the estimated coefficient	A 95% CI for the parameter [LB, UB]
CompStudent	β_1	$\widehat{\beta}_1 = 123.1777$	$se(\widehat{\beta}_1) = 46.28552$	2.66	0.008	[32.19501 , 214.1603]
STR	β_3	$\widehat{\beta}_3 = -1.533944$	$se(\widehat{\beta}_3) = .4943405$	-3.10	0.002	[-2.505661 , -.5622273]
Constant (y-intercept)	β_0	$\widehat{\beta}_0 = 671.4727$	$se(\widehat{\beta}_0) = 11.16598$	60.14	0.000	[649.5239 , 693.4214]

Q2. Test-statistic = $\frac{\widehat{\beta}_3}{se(\widehat{\beta}_3)} = \frac{-1.533944}{.4943405} = -3.10$

Q3. Yes. The p-value of $\widehat{\beta}_3$ is 0.002, which is smaller than 0.05. Therefore, the estimated coefficient is statistically significant at the 5% level. In other words, we reject the null hypothesis that $\beta_3 = 0$, implying that there is a relationship between the ~~computer student ratio~~ **STR** and test scores.